

You are here: Title & Registration Services > Plates > License Plate Overview

License Plate Overview

The Division is authorized to issue license plates to a vehicle. License plates are coated with a reflective material and are designed so the alphanumeric characters and the license plates are sufficient size to be plainly readable, during daylight hours, from a distance of 100 feet.

License plates are assigned during a service at a Customer Service offices and ATPs, while some plates may be ordered through AZ MVD Now.

The license plate is assigned to the vehicle owner, and is attached to the vehicle they own. When the vehicle is sold, the owner retains the license plate, which can be retained as a souvenir or surrendered to the Division. Since the plate is retained by the owner, it may be transferred to another vehicle owned by the customer.

When a plate is eligible to be transferred from vehicle to vehicle, a [Plate Notice, form #48-3302](#) is required. MAX may display a message prompting the form to be completed and submitted; however, the CSR will need to know when the form is needed. View the [Personalized and Special Plates](#) topic > [Transferring a Personalized Plate](#) section for more information on form and transferring plate requirements.

- MAX refers to this form as a Plate Relinquish form

The plate is displayed on the vehicle along with a registration tab.

- One plate is issued
 - If the customer wants a second plate, they may ask for a duplicate plate for \$10.00. View the [Duplicate Plate](#) topic for more information and how to process
- The plate with tab is displayed on the rear of the vehicle
- The tab will indicate the month and year of registration expiration, along with whether the vehicle is registered in the attainment or non-attainment area

Plates, registrations, and tabs are mailed out to the customer. If the temporary plate or registration is lost while waiting for the permanent plate or registration:

- A customer may print a duplicate temporary plate from their Customer Account through AZ MVD Now at no charge
- If a customer comes into the office to request a duplicate temporary plate because theirs has been lost, stolen, or destroyed, a CSR will re-print from the customer's documents and will pay \$5.00

- The [Miscellaneous Purchase](#) service will be used to collect Replacement Plate Fee payment

A plate is issued according to the vehicle's:

- Body style
- Usage
- Owner

There are four different categories of plates for use on a vehicle:

- Regular
- Vehicle Qualifier
- Owner Qualifier (Special Plates)
- Non-Qualifier (Special Plates)



MAX generates and assigns license plate numbers. If a temporary plate generates that looks blatantly derogatory, profane, or inappropriate, or if the customer points out that the plate seems inappropriate (Offensive Standard Plate), the CSR would need to:

- **Complete an**[Update Registration](#) service
- **Select**[Issue New Plate](#) for a new plate to be generated. Fees will need to be zeroed out during the service
- Have your upline approver complete the following to request for refund of incorrect plate if the initial service was completed the same day:
 - Submit a **[Service Portal ticket](#)**
 - **Select**[Special Plates](#) from the Area Impacted drop down
 - In the Detailed description field, begin the description by *typing* the **appropriate cancellation reason**, and then *type* **any additional information** needed
 - Cancellation Reasons:
 - Address Error
 - Burner Plate
 - Offensive Standard Plate
 - Ordered wrong background/Plate Type Error
 - Personalization Error
 - Spacing Error

*If the service is completed **after 4pm on the same day as the initial service**, the customer must be notified that they **MAY** receive both plates **AND** an upline approver should still submit the [Service Portal](#) ticket to the Special Plates Unit (SPU).

****ATPs Only:** This process can only be done Monday thru Friday (not on weekends), as you must submit the form the **SAME** day as processing the plate.

If a customer reports a plate they believe to be inappropriate, and they are not the owner of the plate, please have the customer complete the [License Plate Complaint, form #96-0577](#).

If there is a reason to cancel a plate request (e.g., personalization error, plate type error, wrong address, etc.), view the [Personalized and Special Plates](#) topic > [Plate Ordering Issues](#) section.



When the Special Plates Unit - Plate Support Request form is submitted for an Offensive Standard Plate, this will inform the SPU to place the plate number on the 'no-no' list.

View the [Personalized and Special Plates](#) topic > [License Plate Overview](#) section for more information.

Regular Issued Plates

These plates do not require additional fees for the plate itself and are issued to anyone.

- Commercial

- Motorcycle
- Standard/Passenger
- Trailer

Commercial License Plate

These plates are issued:

- Upon request
- To a vehicle being used commercially
- To a vehicle with a declared gross weight of one ton or more
- To a vehicle with a gross combined weight rating of 26,001+
- To a towed unit with a weight rating that exceeds 10,000 lbs.

Commercially registered trailers will receive a Trailer license plate.

Motorcycle License Plate

These plates are issued to:

- A motorcycle
- A golf cart, depending on Fuel Type
- A motor scooter (49 cc or above)
- A motor driven cycle (49 cc or above)
- An All-Terrain Vehicle (ATV) that is certified as road-worthy

View the [Recreational Vehicles](#) topic for more information on golf carts and ATVs.

Standard License Plate

These plates are issued to non-commercial passenger (owner operator) vehicle:

- Automobiles
- Motor homes
- Trucks (3/4 ton or less)
- Vans/Van Conversions (3/4 ton or less)

Standard plates may also be referenced as shelf or passenger plate.

Maroon Plates

From 1980-1997, the Division issued plates with maroon background and white lettering. These are considered a standard plate (not an antique plate.) These plates are not transferable to another party, only to the same owner (if available in MAX).

Example of Maroon Plate



Trailer License Plate

View the [Trailer Identification](#) topic for more information on Trailer license plates.

Vehicle Qualifier Plates

Depending on vehicle certain plates may be issued, such as Historical Vehicle, Alternative Fuel, or Farm Vehicle license plates.

View the following policies for more information on Vehicle Qualifier Plates:

- [8.16.3 Alternative Fuel License Plate](#)
- [8.16.7 Distinctive Vehicle License Plates](#)
- [8.16.16 Vehicles of Historic Value License Plates](#)

Owner Qualifier (Special Plates and Government Plates)

The owner must have the qualifying characteristic on their record to qualify for these types of plates, view the [Characteristics](#) topic for more information.

View the [Personalized and Special Plates](#) topic for more specific information on qualifications for owner qualifier special plates or policies [8.16.6 Disability-Deaf/Hard of Hearing License Plate/Placard](#), [8.16.11 Owner Qualifier Special Plates](#), and/or [8.16.14 Special Organization License Plates](#) for a specific list of plates.

View the [T&R Scenarios](#) topic >[Adding a Government Exemption to a Vehicle that is Owned by a Government Agency](#) section for instructions on how to title and register a Government Vehicle or for Government Plate information view policy [8.16.7 Distinctive Vehicle License Plates](#).

Non-Qualifier (Special Plates)

For these types of plates, anyone may request them without any qualifications.

View the [Personalized and Special Plates](#) topic for more specific information on special plates or policy [8.16.10 Non-Qualifier Special Plates](#) for a specific list of plates.

Digital License Plates

Digital license plates are available for registered vehicles in Arizona, both standard and motorcycle formats. Digital plates may only be displayed on an ADOT-approved digital license plate display device. The digital license plate display devices are not issued or maintained by the Division.

Currently the only approved vendor is [Reviver](#). The manufacturer determines the plate's cost and MVD does not receive any proceeds from sales.

If a customer wants a digital plate you will refer them to [Reviver.com](#). MVD will continue to manage the issuance of the license plate number and specialty background, if desired. The customer will contact the vendor to have the MVD assigned plate number and background added to the digital format.

Currently there is no way in MAX to see if a customer has a digital plate.

For more information you can visit the [Digital Plate](#) section on AZDOT.gov or [Reviver.com](#) or view the policy [2.7.1 Digital License Plate Display Device](#) for more information on vendors and the display devices.

Policies

[2.7.1 Digital License Plate Display Device](#)

[8.16.1 General License Plate Information](#)

[8.16.2 Personalized License Plate Review](#)

[8.16.3 Alternative Fuel License Plate](#)

[8.16.6 Disability-Deaf/Hard of Hearing License Plate/Placard](#)

[8.16.7 Distinctive Vehicle License Plates](#)

[8.16.10 Non-Qualifier Special Plates](#)

[8.16.11 Owner Qualifier Special Plates](#)

[8.16.12 Personalized License Plate](#)

[8.16.13 Standard License Plates \(Commercial, Motorcycle, Passenger\)](#)

[8.16.14 Special Organization License Plates](#)

[8.16.16 Vehicles of Historic Value License Plates](#)

Forms

[#48-3302 Plate Notice](#)

[#96-0104 Disability-Deaf/Hard of Hearing Plate/Placard Application - Individual](#)

[#96-0104B Organization Disability Plate/Placard Application](#)

HELPFUL LINKS

» [MVD / DMV Public Website](#)

»

Last Updated: May 08, 2026